

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 8 3
♥ 4
♦ Q 9 6
♣ K 9 8 6 5

♠ A J 5

♥ 7 5

♦ A K 7 3

♣ A J 4 2



♠ Q 10 7
♥ K 9 8 2
♦ J 10 8 2
♣ Q 10

♠ 6 4 2

♥ A Q J 10 6 3

♦ 5 4

♣ 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North hand.

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand.
With 6 ♥s you transfer partner by bidding 2♦.
Partner replies 2♥.

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Partner replies 2♥.

Remember, you have invitational strength, so even with a great trump suit you bid just 3♥. Partner puts it in game at 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♦J and West plays the ♦9.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4
Losers are as seen from dummy, the long-trump

You might get lucky in one of the black suits, but your best hope is that East holds the ♥K.

You win the first ♦ and play a ♥ to dummy's ♥10, which wins the trick. You smile. Return to your hand with the other ♦, then play your last ♥ to dummy's ♥J, which wins the trick. But this time you don't smile because West discards! East still holds ♥K 9 and you have no more ♥s to lead for a finesse. Does that finish you?

Never say die. Return to your hand with a black Ace and ruff a ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q 6 and East still has ♥K 9.

Back to your hand with the other black Ace and ruff another ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q and East still has ♥K 9. Play any black card from dummy, then sit back and wait for your two trump tricks!

Bad trump splits can sometimes be countered by a technique called a trump coup.

The coup is accomplished by ruffing to shorten the trump holding so you won't have to play trumps from that holding.

Pretty much like this hand.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 6 3
♥ K Q 7 3
♦ Q 8 7
♣ J 7 2

♠ 8 5 2

♥ J 10 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ Q 10 9 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 7

♥ A 5

♦ A K J 10 3

♣ A K 6

♠ K Q 10 4

♥ 9 8 6 2

♦ 5 4

♣ 8 5 3

West	North	East	South
4NT	Pass	2NT	Pass
All Pass		6NT	

6NT by East

know South holds ♠Q). In fact, you should even give him some incentive to play another ♠ by dropping your ♠9, pretending to hold just the ♠ J 9. But South noticed his partner's discouraging ♠2 and switched to the ♣8.

You try the ♣J but North plays the ♣Q and you have to win with your ♣K.

Your chances for success are slipping away and you are down to your last hope. Your ♠J is a threat that only South can guard against. If South also is the defender with long ♥s then he would also have to guard dummy's fourth ♥. In that case you could squeeze him. But there is one important play you must make for the squeeze to function.

You must play dummy's ♠A to unblock so your ♠J can be the threat you need. Then play the ♥A, ♣A and 5 ♦ winners.

If South has thrown the ♠Q you win your ♠J and dummy's two high ♥s. But since he probably held onto the ♠Q you just play a ♥ to dummy and hope all three ♥s are winners.

Since South had to guard both the ♥s and your ♠J, he was unable to do both, and the squeeze worked.

You were lucky it wasn't North with the 4 ♥s.

Because of his 3-4-3-3 distribution, partner chose not to look for a ♥ fit. If he had opted for Stayman the contract would have turned out the same. The 4NT response is quantitative, inviting you to bid 6NT if you have a maximum.

You do. 6NT.

East plays 6NT. South leads the ♠K. You will have to make an early decision on whether to hold up or not.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 5 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 11

Only one more winner is needed. You should play a low ♠ from dummy in the hope that South will lead the suit again, giving you a trick with your ♠J (you